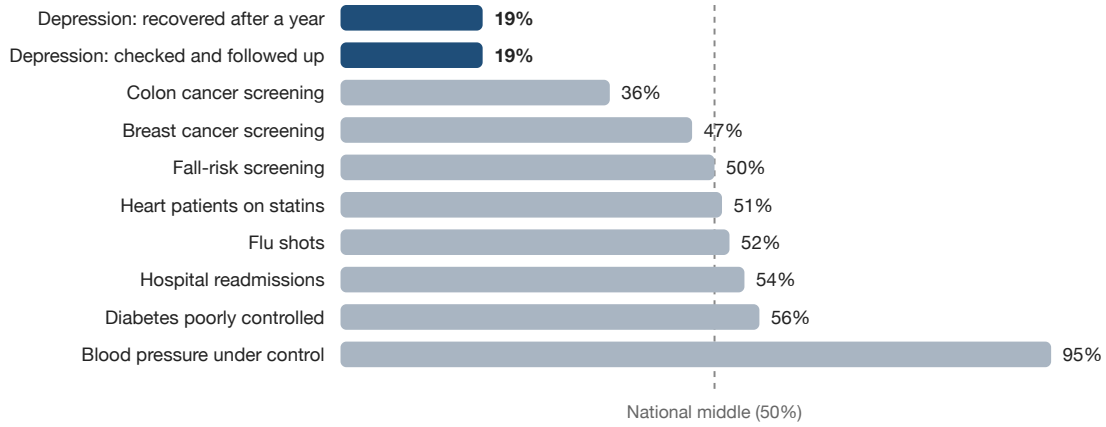
Charts: Why Depression Scores Are Low, and the Fix

Nancy Yeo · Clinical Quality Analyst candidate, Torrance Memorial · The same charts as the online dashboard

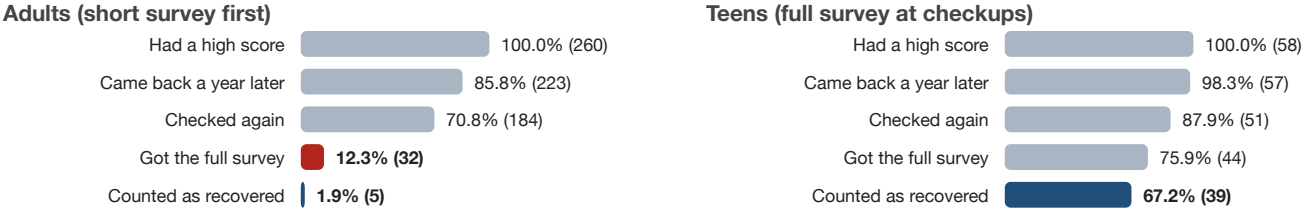
1. Torrance Memorial vs. other networks REAL DATA, 2024

How many of the country's doctor networks Torrance Memorial beats on each Medicare quality score. It beats 95% on blood pressure but only 19% on depression. Longer bar = better.



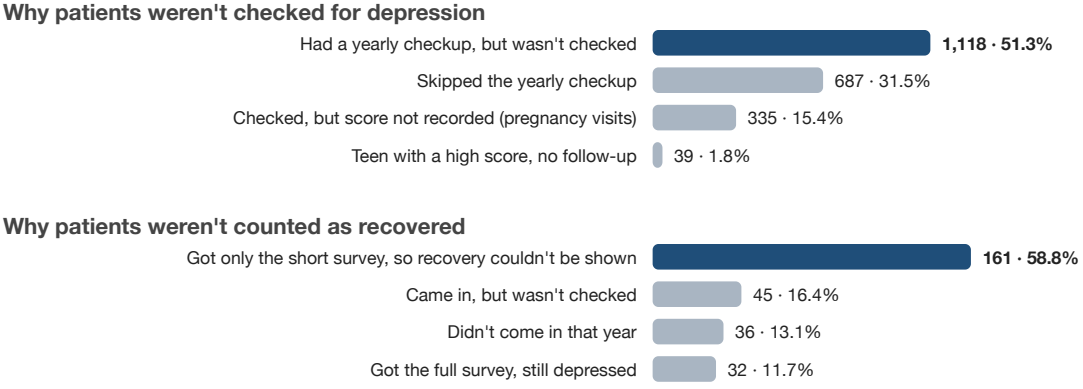
2. The main finding SIMULATED DATA

Patients may be getting better, but they aren't given the survey that proves it. We followed patients with a high depression score for a year. Most adults came back and were checked, but only 12.3% got the full 9-question survey, the only one that can show recovery (red bar). Teens get the full survey at every checkup.



3. Why patients are missed SIMULATED DATA

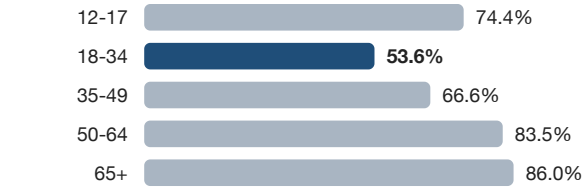
Half of the patients missed for depression checks (1,118 of 2,179) came in for a yearly checkup and still weren't checked. Bars show the share of missed patients for each reason.



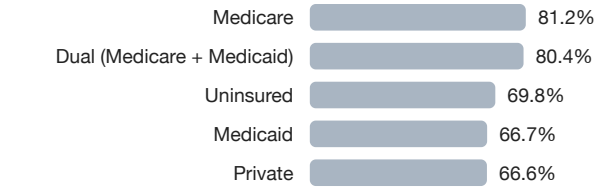
4. Who gets missed SIMULATED DATA

Share of patients checked for depression in 2025. Young adults (18–34) are checked least, 53.6% vs. 86.0% for 65+, because many skip yearly checkups.

By age band



By insurance



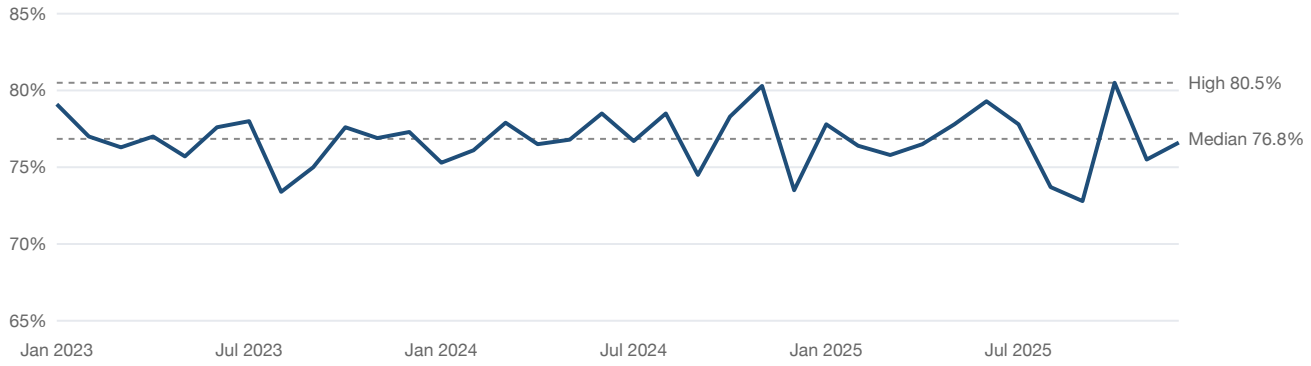
5. Every possible fix, compared SIMULATED DATA

The three recommended changes are highlighted: cheap, fast, and no new staff. Together they raise the share checked from 70.8% to **80.4%**. "After" assumes half of visits use the change; recovery numbers use the most cautious estimate.

Change	Effort	Time	Patients helped	Measure	Now	After
Require a depression check at every yearly checkup	**Low**	**1-3 months**	**1,118**	**Checked**	**70.8%**	**78.2%**
Add a box to record the score at pregnancy visits	**Low**	**1-2 months**	**335**	**Checked**	**70.8%**	**73.0%**
Give the full survey a year later to past high scorers	**Low**	**1-3 months**	**161**	**Recovered**	**13.8%**	**17.8%**
Check at any visit if it's been a year	Medium	3-6 months	687	Checked	70.8%	75.4%
Fast mental-health referral for teens with a high score	Medium	3-6 months	39	Checked	70.8%	71.0%
Same, at any visit that year	Low	1-3 months	45	Recovered	13.8%	14.9%
Send the full survey by phone or patient portal	Medium	3-6 months	36	Recovered	13.8%	14.7%

6. How we'll know it's working SIMULATED DATA

Share of yearly checkups that include a depression check, by month. It has stayed around 77% for three years and never gone above 80.5%. After the changes, a month above that line is the first sign they're working.



Real: CMS Medicare Shared Savings Program, performance year 2024. **Simulated:** fake patient records built to look real (real records are private); a lead to confirm, not Torrance Memorial's actual numbers. Full survey = PHQ-9; short survey = PHQ-2. Full SQL and validation: github.com/yeonancy56/depression-care-gap-analysis